

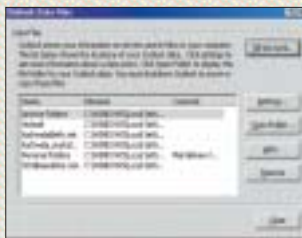
e-mail address of the intended person and press Send.

Manage PST file size

All the e-mails in Microsoft Outlook are saved in a single file with a PST extension. If you have used Outlook for a long time, the size of the .pst file will be large. Keeping the file down to a manageable size is a problem. One way to reduce the file size is to archive the old items. The archived items are then moved to another PST file. But the archive file size will also increase over a period of time.

Another way is to create many data files—one for personal mail, one for department mail, one for company mail, one for external client mail, and so on. In this way the mails will be split over different files, resulting in smaller single files.

To make a new data file go to **File > Data File Management**. Press Add to add a new data file, then select the 'Types of storage' as Personal Folder File (*.pst), name the new PST file and press OK. You can now view the new folder. By default, it contains a Deleted Items folder. Now you need to add sub-folders to store e-mails in, and create new sort-



Control the PST file size with Data Management

ing rules that will redirect your incoming mails to this folder.

Add holidays

Marking the holidays on your Outlook calendar will make it easier for you to plan around them. Outlook does have a way to add holidays, but you will find no entry for India. To personalise it to Indian holidays, you need to modify the Outlook.txt or Outlook.hol file.

Locate the Outlook.txt or Outlook.hol file and open it using word pad. The file contains a list of holidays—



You can add holidays using the calendar options

one per line, grouped by the country name. Go to the bottom of the file and add a new group name—'India' in square brackets, followed by a number, denoting the total number of entries. Finally add the names and dates of the holidays you want to mark.

It should look something like this:

[India] 3

Republic Day: 2003/01/26

Independence Day: 2003/8/15

Gandhi Jayanti: 2003/10/2

You can add as many hol-

idays as you want, as long as you add the proper count after the square brackets. Now, go to **Tools > Options > Calendar Options > Add Holidays**, search for the entry 'India', select it and press OK.

Add-ins

Outlook has add-ins to facilitate and automate many frequent tasks. These are easily downloadable from the Internet. Here are some of the more popular ones.

Manage attachments

Attachment add-ins help in extracting attachments from e-mails into a folder. Most add-ins remove the attachments but add a link to the file in the e-mail. An example of one such add-in is TODI. The add-in and information on how to install and use it is available at



Automatically sort your attachments in to specific folders

<http://www.aufgang.org/koch/homepage/software/todi.htm>

Auto print

The print add-ins are for offices that constantly require to print e-mails. Add-ins in this category print the e-mail as soon as it arrives. One such add-in

can be bought at <http://www.sperrysoftware.com>

Always inform BOSS

Some organisations pass about a large amount of correspondence in the form of e-mails. In such cases, it is mostly mandatory to mark a copy to the project or department head, so that the progress of the project can be tracked. Certain add-ins put in a default e-mail address, that is added to every e-mail that is sent, without the knowledge of the sender. One such add-in, called 'Always BCC', can be bought at www.sperrysoftware.com

Time stamp

Sometimes your e-mails take hours to reach the receivers, even over an Intranet. There are add-ins that time stamp the exact time and date of when you sent an e-mail. This helps to keep an exact record of important e-mails. These add-ins can be enabled or disabled with a mouse click. You can get one such add-in from <http://www.sperrysoftware.com/jc/TimeDateSignature.asp>

Mass mail

Mass mailing has become the new mantra of marketing gurus, add-ins that enable Mass mailing from Outlook are available. The add-ins vary in the features they provide—some just help you send e-mails, while others help you sort the responses as well. PC iMail is available at <http://www.prosoftapps.com/pcimail.htm>. It can extract